

dollars. But that's also a good thing. It means they want our business, and will sometimes give us quite a few discounts to get it!

Each company should have its own list of available discounts on their website, but even if they don't, be assertive and ask exactly what they can give you that other companies can't. Here's a list of the most typical offers:

- Bundling your policies
- Maintaining good credit
- Being part of an association, such as an alumni of a university
- Being employed with a particular company
- Maintaining low mileage
- Installing specific car safety features (car alarms, anti-lock brakes, etc.)
- Maintaining good grades in school
- Enrolling in paperless statements

Depending on what promotions companies are currently running, you could also take advantage of specific driving rewards programs. Just be sure it will truly save you money—some programs offer rewards, but charge a higher rate.

READER TIP:

These tips are approved by an insurance agent—me! I no longer work as an agent, but I did for three years. Sometimes the cash back incentive for no accidents actually raises your rates, so you're paying extra to get your own money back. It's better not to take it in my opinion.

—Jamie, MD